

Connotation - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Public Meeting

One speaker called the proposed rule a safeguard; another called it a restriction.

1. What does safeguard emphasize?

- A. protection
- B. punishment
- C. confusion
- D. speed

2. Why does restriction create a different impression?

- A. It focuses attention on limits rather than protection.
- B. It changes the rule into a law.
- C. It makes the rule shorter.
- D. It makes the speaker neutral.

Repair Shop

A customer wrote that the technician carefully explained the problem; another review said the technician slowly explained it.

3. Which word is more approving?

- A. carefully
- B. slowly
- C. problem
- D. technician

4. What is the main difference in effect?

- A. carefully evaluates quality; slowly mainly describes pace
- B. slowly proves the explanation was wrong
- C. carefully changes the identity of the technician
- D. there is no difference

Neighborhood Article

The writer says new trees softened the look of the parking lot.

5. What does softened suggest?

- A. The trees made the area seem less harsh or severe.
- B. The trees physically melted the pavement.
- C. The parking lot became unsafe.
- D. The trees made cars quieter.

6. Which replacement is most neutral?

- A. beautified
- B. transformed
- C. changed
- D. rescued

Answer key and reasoning

Public Meeting

1. A. Safeguard carries a positive protective association.
2. A. Restriction frames the same policy through loss of freedom or limitation.

Repair Shop

3. A. Carefully suggests attention and care, while slowly may be neutral or negative depending on context.
4. A. The words emphasize different aspects: quality/attention versus speed.

Neighborhood Article

5. A. Softened carries a positive visual association of making the scene gentler.
6. C. Changed states a difference without evaluating it positively or dramatically.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.